
Policy framework

The Council's policies and strategies are linked through a [Policy Framework \[PDF\]](#) set out in the Council's constitution. At the top of this framework is a strategic vision for Nottinghamshire, this set out the ambitions, values and priorities for everyone at the County Council to follow. These priorities are set every four years and provide the major goals and improvements to be achieved across our services.

The Council's policies are guided by the strategic vision for Nottinghamshire established in Your Nottinghamshire, the Council Plan 2017 – 2021. Our policies should complement the ambitions, values and priorities set out in the Strategic Plan.

To ensure that the County Council achieves its strategic vision the Policy Framework sets out that the vision will be accompanied by a Plan. The Council will often develop a strategy to set out how we will achieve a specific ambition.

One Council: One Policy

The Council's policies will usually apply across the whole Council and will be agreed by Councillors through the Policy Committee. In some very limited circumstances they may also be agreed at meetings of the Full Council.

In developing new policies, strategies or statutory plans or reviewing existing ones, the Council will generally seek to develop ones that cover the whole authority as part of the One Council approach. The policy framework allows for consideration to be given to individual/service needs/exceptions as part of these policies but specific policies for individual service areas should generally be avoided.

As part of our commitment to be open and transparent, all of our policies and strategies are being made available from a [policy library](#). The library brings together the definitive versions of all of these documents into a single point of reference.

New and changed policies will be added to the library as they are approved by councillors. The Council will also regularly review all of its policies and as part of this process consideration will be given to opportunities to amalgamate any documentation duplicated across different parts of the Authority into a single One Council policy.

Approval – Implementation/Delivery – Achievements

When the Council changes approach or develops new policies/strategies it will usually be to achieve a particular ambition or outcome as part of our Strategic Vision. Through the policy framework the Council recognises that this ambition/outcome will not usually be achieved without supporting activity, therefore new or changed policies/strategies will usually be expected to be accompanied by a Plan.

In the case of a new or revised policy/strategy, the plan will set out the action to be taken to take the Council from the present position to a position where the concept is fully implemented. Progress implementing this – through the plan - should be reported.

Council Strategies should include or be accompanied by a delivery plan of the actions to be taken to achieve the ambitions/outcomes sought. Progress delivering the strategy – through the plan - should also be reported.

For guidance and support with the aforementioned tasks, please contact the Performance, Intelligence and Policy (PIP) Team via: policy@nottsc.gov.uk

Key Definitions

	Definition	Example
Policy	A set of principles that the County Council will follow in providing services, developing services and taking decisions about services and other matters.	“NCC often works with other organisations to deliver a product, service or initiative. In these instances the NCC brand mark must sit alongside the partner organisations' brand marks.” ↑

Strategy	A document setting out an high level approach to deliver one or more key policy commitments.	“Our Council Plan 2017-2021 sets out our promises to the people of Nottinghamshire, our priorities and how we aim to support the people of our county to be aspirational, independent and to share with us responsibility for the future.”
Procedure	The approach that will be followed by the County Council in accordance with policy.	“To ensure the details of the partnership are clear, a set of rules detailing how to visually represent the various partner relationships has been produced.”
Guidance	Day to day operational direction, compliant with policy and procedures.	“The following pages show examples of how to apply these rules.”